ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	52nd Commission Meeting
DATE:	26 October, 2021
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	CP's Chamber

#	AGENDA	DECISIONS
1	Issues related to hiring Annual Report translator – PPS	The Commission noted the challenges confronted with regard to Dzongkha translation of Annual Report 2020 – 2021, which was awarded through open quotation to a private firm called 'iBEST Institute and Consultancy'. Besides simple typographical and grammatical errors, the translators had limited practical experience in translating technical reports like that of the ACC. Moreover, the translators lacked competence to comprehend the essence of issues and propositions presented in the Annual Report. As a result, the reviewing team instituted from within the ACC had to redo all the translations submitted by the firm. Due to limited time for onward submission to the Parliament, the translated sections could neither be referred back to the firm for enrichment nor terminate and retender the contract. Towards meeting the deadline, the review team had to work round the clock including weekends. To this, the Commission directed the following: • Awarding of future consultancy services for translation must take practical experiences of the firm in translating the ACC reports into consideration and not fully going by the lowest quoted price. Further, CVs of those individuals proposed as translators must be verified. • In the event a suitable firm cannot be recruited for translation services, due to lack of technical competencies, an internal team will be formed and accordingly planned in respective IWPs of the team members. In doing so, the PPS must hereafter plan the procurement of translation consultancy services of Annual Report within June. • Henceforth, to avoid such last-minute hassles, all the Departments/Divisions/Services concerned must start preparing respective inputs including data reconciliation by mid-May and by all means submit to the PPS by mid-July. • Further, PPS must start reminding the respective Departments/Divisions/Services on the preparation for Annual Report by February.

2	Sharing Annual Report 2020 – 2021 for on-going ACA Assessment – PPS	Directed the PPS to share the Annual Report 2020 – 2021 to the consultant for ACA Strengthening Initiative Assessment once the formal presentations to the respective Good Governance Committees of the National Assembly and National Council are made on 3 November 2021. Further, directed to convey the need to ensure strict confidentiality and refrain from any kind of publication before deliberation in the upcoming Parliament session.
3	Others i) Verification of AD during the upcoming 3rd LG Elections	Directed the ADMD to prepare with internal strategy for coping with the request from the ECB in verifying the AD filed by aspiring candidates for the upcoming 3rd LG Elections. To this effect, inform the official concerned at the ECB that if the request is overwhelming, the ACC will institute a system of issuing provisional certificates. Further, to complement the existing staff in the ADMD, start training some officials from within DoPE & other Departments/Divisions/Services to work on the verification. In addition, remind all the ACC staff on the registration of postal ballot for the upcoming Elections.
	ii) Update on the troubleshooting of data security and storage issues	Directed the ICTS to apprise the Commission on the status of data security and storage including remedies implemented towards data backup. Further, given the acute manpower shortage in the ICTS, the Commission directed the HRS and Head of Secretariat Services to explore for succession planning in the ICTS.
	iii) ATRs shared with the RCSC *In continuation to the decision of 51st Commission Meeting held on 19 October 2021*	In continuation to the earlier directives from the Commission on reviewing the effectiveness of ATRs shared with the RCSC, the Commission further directed the DoPS to review all the ATRs shared between 2017 till date from the perspective of *disparity, leniency* and *grading* of disciplinary actions enforced by the agencies. Similarly, directed the LD to review the provisions in the BCSR and RUB Service Rules on how these rules actually facilitate enforcing disciplinary actions vis-à-vis gaps. Accordingly, the outputs of these two reviews may be consolidated to ensure holistic perspective in managing ATRs.

Commissioner — Tour — **Commissioner** **Chairperson**